AI Acceptable-Use Policy

Maple & Birch Bookkeeping (SAMPLE) · Edmonton, Alberta · 8 staff Version 1.0 · Approved by: Owner (SAMPLE) · Approved on: 2026-11-02 · Next review: 2027-02-01

> **SAMPLE: fictional office.** "Maple & Birch Bookkeeping" is made up to show what a Clear Rules client document looks like. This is general guidance, not legal advice. Clear Rules Cyber Security makes no promise of compliance with any law, insurance result, or security outcome.

1. Why we have this policy

Our staff handle clients' tax, payroll, and banking information every day. AI tools like ChatGPT and Microsoft Copilot can save time, but whatever we type or upload can leave our control. This policy says which AI tools we use, what may go into them, and who checks the results.

We are an Alberta business, so the **Personal Information Protection Act (Alberta PIPA)** applies to the personal information we collect, use, and disclose. Where personal information crosses provincial or national borders in commercial activity, the federal **PIPEDA** may also apply. Both laws expect us to collect, use, and disclose personal information only for reasonable purposes, with consent unless the law allows otherwise, and to protect it with reasonable security arrangements. Under PIPA, we must notify the Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner of Alberta, without unreasonable delay, of any loss of, or unauthorized access to or disclosure of, personal information under our control where a reasonable person would consider there is a real risk of significant harm to an individual. The Commissioner may then require us to notify the affected individuals. Where PIPEDA applies, a breach that creates a real risk of significant harm must be reported to the Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada, and the affected individuals notified. This policy is one of the ways we try to meet those duties. It is not legal advice. Questions about what the law requires go to our lawyer.

2. Who it covers

Everyone who does work for Maple & Birch: owners, employees, contractors, and students, on any device, including personal phones used for work.

3. Approved tools

Only the tools in our **Approved-Tools Register** may be used for work, and only with the **company account** listed there. Personal or free accounts are not approved for any client or staff information. To ask for a new tool or a new AI feature, email the Policy Owner. We use the **Vendor AI Checklist** before approving anything.

4. What may go into an AI tool

Colour	What it is	Rule

GREEN	Public or general information: published website text, general tax questions with no client details, our own templates	OK in any approved tool
AMBER	Internal, non-identifying work: internal procedures, anonymized examples ("a client with two rental properties")	Approved company accounts only
RED	Anything that identifies a client or staff member: names, SINs, addresses, account numbers, T4s/T5s, payroll, CRA correspondence, bank statements	**Never** into a general AI chatbot. Only into a tool the Register marks "RED allowed", and only with the Policy Owner's written OK for that task
NEVER	Passwords, MFA codes, online-banking logins, CRA "Represent a Client" credentials, keys	Never into any AI tool, under any circumstances

When unsure, treat it as RED and ask.

5. Checking the output

AI can be confidently wrong. A named person must check, before it is sent or relied on:

- any number, calculation, tax rule, or deadline (check against the CRA source, not a second AI answer)
- anything sent to a client, CRA, or a bank
- any summary of a client document

AI never makes the final decision on a client's filing, a payment, or an HR matter.

6. Telling people

We don't present AI-written work as specialist advice. If a client asks whether AI was used on their file, we answer honestly.

7. Payments and impersonation

AI makes fake voices and emails convincing. No one changes banking details or sends money because of an email, text, or call alone. Always call back on a number already on file. Report anything odd with the **Report-a-Concern Form**.

8. If something goes wrong

If client or staff information went into a tool it shouldn't have, or you see something strange, **tell the Policy Owner the same day** using the Report-a-Concern Form. You won't be punished for a prompt, honest report. The Policy Owner decides next steps, including whether the matter must be reported to the Information and Privacy Commissioner of Alberta (PIPA) or the Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada (PIPEDA), and whether affected clients must be notified. We keep a record of every privacy breach, including ones we don't report, for at least 24 months.

9. Roles

- **Policy Owner:** Owner (SAMPLE). Keeps this policy, the Register, and the sign-off record.
- **Everyone:** reads the Quick Rules, signs the Acknowledgement, asks when unsure.

10. Breaking the rules

A first, honest mistake is a coaching conversation. Repeated or deliberate breaches follow our normal HR process.

11. Review

Reviewed every quarter using the **Quarterly Review Template**, and whenever we add a tool or a vendor changes how its AI handles data. Each version is dated, and staff re-sign when the rules change.

Version	Date	Change	Approved by
1.0	2026-11-02	First policy	Owner (SAMPLE)